

SYN Flood Attack

In the normal course of a TCP connection, a SYN (TCP connection request) is sent to a target computer. When the target computer receives the SYN, it sends a SYN_RECEIVED message back to the machine that sent the SYN (reading the IP source address of the originating packet). The target computer then waits for the machine that originated the request to send back a SYN_ACK upon receipt of its SYN_RECEIVED message (this SYN_RECEIVED state is saved in a buffer either until the ACK is received or until the request has been waiting for a particular finite period of time and is then purged). When this three-way handshake is completed, data can travel freely between the two computers.

Telnet Server

Software that allows a remote user of a Telnet client to connect as a remote terminal from anywhere on the Internet and control a computer in which the server software is running.

Time Bomb

A logic bomb with its trigger condition(s) based on absolute or elapsed date or time conditions.

TOM

Top of Memory. A design limit at the 640 KB-mark on most PCs. Often the boot record does not completely reach top of memory, thus leaving empty space. Boot sector infectors often try to conceal themselves by hiding around the top of memory. Checking the top of memory value for changes can help detect a virus, though there is also non-viral reasons this value change.

Tracking Cookie

Any cookie that is shared among two or more Web pages for the purpose of tracking a user's surfing history.

Trigger

The condition that determines the launching of a virus' or Trojan's payload is usually called the trigger or trigger condi-